

Robert S. Ricks Jr.

rricks5000@gmail.com | 251-215-0360

Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University (Virginia Tech)
Pamplin College of Business | 880 W. Campus Dr., Blacksburg, VA 24060

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA

- Ph.D. in Accounting and Information Systems 2024 – 2029 (Expected)

Auburn University, Auburn, AL

- Master of Accountancy (MAcc) 2018 – 2019
- B.S. in Business Administration, Accountancy (Summa Cum Laude) 2015 – 2017

Certified Public Accountant (No. 14128), State of Alabama Active

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA

- *Graduate Research Assistant and Teaching Instructor* 2024 – Present

BBB Industries, LLC, Daphne, AL

- *Tax Senior Analyst* 2023 – 2024

Warren Averett, LLC, Foley, AL

- *Tax Senior* 2020 – 2023

Deloitte, LLP, Atlanta, GA

- *Tax Consultant - Business Tax Services - Real Estate* 2019 – 2020

Auburn University, Auburn, AL

- *Graduate Teaching Assistant* 2018 – 2019

RESEARCH

Interests: Financial Reporting, Human Capital

Research Methods: Archival, Survey

Works in Progress:

“Accounting Student Decisions Following the Alternative CPA Licensure Pathway: Survey Evidence on Master’s Programs and CPA Exam Intentions”

- **Advisor:** Robert Davidson
- **Summary:** This paper gathers survey data from accounting undergraduate and graduate students, as well as accounting master's program directors, to examine planned student enrollment decisions and planned CPA exam taking following the lowering of CPA licensure education requirements in the alternative pathway.
- **Status:** Draft in progress.
- **Presentations:** Second Year Paper Presentation, Virginia Tech PhD Program (2026, planned)

“Are state tax agency employees impacted by federal enforcement staffing changes?” with Andrew Acito, Michelle Nessa, and Logan Natvig

- **Summary:** This paper examines the relationship between cuts to federal tax employees who are physically located in a state and subsequent impacts on employment at that state’s tax agency.
- **Status:** Data collection in progress.

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

A = Attendee | D = Discussant | R = Reviewer | P = Presenter

Virginia Tech Accounting Research Conference A	2026
Virginia Accounting Research Conference (VARC) A	2026
Financial Accounting and Reporting Section (FARS) Midyear Meeting A, R	2026
International Accounting Section (IAS) Midyear Meeting R	2026
Virginia Accounting Research Conference (VARC) A	2025
Virginia Tech Accounting Research Conference A	2024

TEACHING

Courses Taught at Virginia Tech

ACIS 2116: Intro to Managerial Accounting – two sections (rating: 4.99/6)	2025
ACIS 3314: Tax Impact on Decisions – Led quiz review class for 3 sections	2026

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Accounting and Information Systems Alumni Scholarship	2026
Ronald J. Patten Scholarship in Accounting and Information Systems	2026
AICPA Foundation Fellowship for Accounting Doctoral Students	2026
Thomas M. Berry Scholarship from the Virginia Society of Certified Public Accountants (VSCPA)	2026
Thomas M. Wells and Kathy Dargo Accounting and Information Systems Fellowship	2024, 2025

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

AAA weARE Webinar: How to Communicate Academic Research to a Broad Audience	2026
AI’s Impact on the Future of Graduate Education & Research Workshop (VT)	2026
Pamplin AI Teaching Workshop (VT)	2026
AAA weARE webinar: Using Collaborative Learning Techniques to Teach Ethics to Accounting Students	2025
AAA weARE webinar: Integrating Ethics into the Accounting Curriculum	2025

REVIEWS

Web of Science Researcher ID: PJT-7784-2026

Verified peer reviews:

Asian Review of Accounting 2